



WORKSHEET

E-Commerce Conversion Audit

A practical, evidence-first worksheet for tracing the customer journey, identifying friction, and deciding what deserves attention next.

Follow one customer journey from first visit to completed order, record what happens, and use the evidence to decide where the real friction is.

Designed to be used as a working document, not a sales pitch.

Start with the journey, not the conversion rate.

An e-commerce conversion audit works best when it asks where a customer gets confused, hesitant, distracted, or unable to finish. The numbers tell you where to look. The customer journey helps you understand why.

How to use this audit

Pick a specific customer journey - for example, an organic search visitor buying one product on a phone. Follow the journey from landing page to post-purchase confirmation. Record what you actually observe, then separate evidence from interpretation.

Stage	Record	Questions to answer
Discovery	Source / entry page	Why might this visitor arrive here? Does the page match the promise that brought them?
Browse	Category/search behavior	Can they find the right product without knowing the exact product name?
Evaluate	Product page	What questions are answered? What questions remain?
Decide	Trust / offer	What could create confidence? What could create doubt?
Cart	Cart behavior	Are price, shipping, quantity and availability clear?
Checkout	Checkout behavior	Where does friction appear? What is required that is not necessary?
Purchase	Transaction	Does the purchase complete and get recorded correctly?
After purchase	Confirmation / support	Does the customer know what happens next?

1. Baseline the evidence

Before changing the site, record the current state. Otherwise it is easy to mistake seasonality, traffic quality, inventory, or tracking changes for a UX improvement.

Metric / signal	Current evidence	What it may mean	Confidence
Sessions / product views			
Add-to-cart rate			
Checkout start rate			
Purchase conversion rate			
Revenue / AOV			
Checkout abandonment			
Device split			
Top landing pages			

2. Discovery and landing-page audit

Look at the promise made before the customer reaches the product page. A mismatch between source and landing page can make a “conversion problem” that is actually a relevance problem.

- ☐ Does the landing page clearly match the search query, ad, email, social post, or referral that brought the visitor?
- ☐ Is the product or category available without unnecessary scrolling or hunting?
- ☐ Are internal links and navigation clear enough to continue when the first product is not the right fit?
- ☐ Does the page load quickly enough to be usable on the customer's likely device and connection?
- ☐ Are important pages crawlable and indexable without accidental technical barriers?

3. Product evaluation audit

The goal is not to maximize the amount of content. It is to answer the questions that determine whether this specific buyer can make a decision.

- ☐ Can a first-time visitor identify the product and its main use immediately?
- ☐ Are images useful rather than decorative filler?
- ☐ Are price, availability, variants, delivery expectations, returns, and warranty information easy to find?
- ☐ Does the page give enough evidence to support the claims it makes?
- ☐ Are reviews and trust signals credible and appropriately presented?
- ☐ Does the page make the product seem like a good fit for the intended customer without hiding tradeoffs?

4. Cart audit

A cart should confirm the decision rather than introduce new uncertainty.

- ☐ Customer can see what they added, including variant/size/color details where relevant.
- ☐ Quantity changes and removals work immediately and are clearly reflected.
- ☐ Estimated shipping, taxes, discounts, and total are understandable.
- ☐ The next step is obvious, especially on mobile.
- ☐ The cart does not introduce avoidable upsells that distract from the intended purchase path.
- ☐ Error states are clear when inventory changes or a promotion no longer applies.

5. Checkout audit

Checkout friction is often a mixture of usability, trust, policy, and payment issues. Treat them separately.

Checkpoint	Observation	Severity	Evidence / next test
Account requirement			
Field count / data request			
Shipping selection			
Tax / total clarity			

Checkpoint	Observation	Severity	Evidence / next test
Payment methods			
Error messages			
Trust / reassurance			
Confirmation			

6. Measurement audit

Before calling a change successful, make sure the measurement can actually support the conclusion.

- ☐ Events are firing once and on the correct user action.
- ☐ Transaction IDs and purchase values are stable enough to reconcile analytics with orders.
- ☐ Products and variants retain consistent identifiers between the site and analytics implementation where supported.
- ☐ Internal test orders are not inflating conversion reporting.
- ☐ Consent behavior is understood and documented for the customer base being served.
- ☐ Important changes are tagged with dates so results can be reviewed later.

7. Find the bottleneck before proposing a redesign

A low conversion rate does not tell you what the cause is. A useful audit narrows the problem.

Observed pattern	Questions before changing the site
High traffic, low product engagement	Is traffic relevant? Is the landing page aligned with intent?
High product views, low add-to-cart	Is the offer understandable? Price, proof, variant choice or shipping uncertainty?
High add-to-cart, low checkout start	Is the cart introducing cost, friction or confusion?
High checkout start, low purchase	Is payment, form entry, trust or technical failure causing the drop?
Good conversion, weak revenue	Is AOV, margin, discounting, inventory or product mix the constraint?
Mobile much weaker than desktop	Is there a touch, speed, layout, keyboard or checkout-specific problem?

8. Audit conclusion

The conclusion should describe the evidence and the most defensible next step. It does not have to be “redesign the website.”

Finding	Evidence	Recommended next action	How to know it worked
Priority 1			
Priority 2			
Priority 3			

A good audit leaves the business clearer than it found it.

The point of this worksheet is not to produce a dramatic list of problems. It is to help a business separate a real customer or revenue problem from a cosmetic preference, a tracking gap, a merchandising issue, or a platform limitation. Sometimes the right action is a redesign. Sometimes it is a product-page fix, a checkout change, a better offer, better traffic, better measurement, or no change at all.

Current reference points

Google Search Central - Merchant listings structured data:

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/merchant-listing>

Google Search Central - Product variants: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/product-variants>

Google Search Central - Search Essentials: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials>

Google Analytics - Ecommerce measurement concepts: <https://developers.google.com/analytics/devguides/collection/ga4/ecommerce>

web.dev - Core Web Vitals: <https://web.dev/articles/vitals>